

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥4

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥8

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥J

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

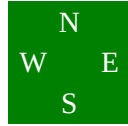
♣ 6 4 2

♠ A 10 8

♥ A 10 9

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ K 9 7



♠ 6 5 4

♥ K 6 5 4 3

♦ A 7

♣ A 5 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥4

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

NORTH has a mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking NORTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But NORTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ K 7 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 10 9 8 6 2

♦ A 7

♣ 5 4 2



♠ K Q J

♥ A 4

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ A J 7 3

♠ A 5 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ J 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 8

EAST has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

WEST has 8 points. She adds EAST's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥Q

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

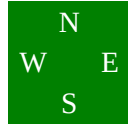
♠ J 3 2
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ 9 8 7 4 3
 ♣ 9 4

♠ A 10 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2



♠ 9 7 6 5
 ♥ 10 7 6 2
 ♦ 10
 ♣ A 10 6 5

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3

SOUTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if SOUTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

NORTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to SOUTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to SOUTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			
Lead: ♥8			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 5
♥ K 8 5
♦ Q 10 7 6
♣ A 9 7

♠ K 3 2
♥ J 10 9 3 2
♦ 8
♣ Q J 6 3



♠ 10 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K 10 5 2

♠ J 9 7 6
♥ A 4
♦ A 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	2NT	
All Pass			
2NT by West			
Lead: ♥J			

WEST has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

EAST has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since WEST is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.